

Question 32 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

State any two purposes of feedback in HRD practices.

Introduction

Feedback in HRD is specific information given to a person (or by a person upward to the organisation) about behaviour or results, so that learning can happen. It is not scolding, and it is not vague praise. For 8 marks, state two main purposes in depth, then add other purposes so the answer is complete.

Detailed points

- 1. First purpose — to improve current performance.** The employee needs to know where he or she stands against expectations in time to correct. A cook told the same day that the gravy is too salty can change tonight's food. A yearly remark 'food average' cannot. This purpose is corrective. Without it, errors repeat and customers suffer. In HRD language, feedback reduces the gap between standard and actual when the person can control that gap.
- 2. How this purpose is carried out.** Immediate, behaviour-focused comments by the supervisor; mid-period reviews; quality checklists discussed with the worker. Tone matters: respect keeps the person open. Humiliation makes the person defend, not improve — then this purpose fails even if the information was correct.
- 3. Second purpose — to support learning and long-term development.** Feedback is how people learn from work itself, which the notes call informal HRD (coaching by a manager). It reinforces what is going well so that good behaviour continues, and it guides training, stretch jobs and career choices. Example: 'You explain products clearly; you still freeze when the customer is angry' points both to a strength to use and to a skill to train. Development becomes targeted.
- 4. Motivation as a related purpose.** Recognition through honest positive feedback meets higher-order needs — achievement and esteem — which HRD stresses compared with only monetary motivation in HRM. People repeat what is noticed.
- 5. Role clarification.** Feedback often reveals that the employee and the boss did not share the same picture of the job. Clarifying the role develops the dyad, an HRD system goal.
- 6. Climate-building purpose.** Open, respectful, two-way feedback signals trust and openness (HRD climate). Absent or only negative feedback signals fear. So feedback is both a tool and a climate message.
- 7. System improvement and evaluation.** Upward feedback tells the organisation about broken processes and poor support. Feedback after training (reaction, behaviour) improves HRD design. These are purposes beyond the single employee.
- 8. Exam caution.** Write two purposes as long paragraphs with examples, then a cluster of other purposes. Do not define feedback in one line and stop.

Conclusion. Two central purposes of feedback in HRD are (1) to improve present performance through timely, specific information, and (2) to support learning and development by reinforcing strengths and guiding next growth steps. Motivation, role clarity, climate and system improvement are additional purposes. Feedback is information for growth, not insult.